

Darkling beetles
can run at 1 m
(3 ft) per second.

Locust

A tiny flea can jump
100 times its own length.
It can also jump 600 times
per hour non-stop for
three days while looking
for an animal to settle on.

Jumping

Some insects can jump huge distances by using their back legs as powerful springs. If a grasshopper is disturbed, its catapult-like legs help it to get away.

Turn and learn

Caterpillars
pp. 108-109

Flies:
pp. 126-127

These caterpillars have suckers at either end of their bodies to hold onto, and loop up, twigs.

Flea

Darkling beetle

Running

Insects' legs reflect where they live. Beetles that live under bark have short legs that don't get in the way.

Darkling beetles have long legs that let them race across hot sand in the desert.

Locusts, a kind of grasshopper, can jump up to 1 m (3 ft) high.